One-Hour Zone Timers

One room zone, five small stretches, one honest break. Go.

Today's zone:

Start time: _____ Total zones done this week: _____

Stretch 1 • 10 min — Trash & speed return — 0:00 – 0:10

Bin empty, dishes out, obvious junk gathered. Grab stray cups and trash on your very first walk in. Nothing detailed, nothing precious — just clear and quick.

Stretch 2 • 15 min — Home base reset — 0:10 – 0:25

Return every stray item to where it belongs. Don't fix barely-organized corners here — just get things home. If it has no home, it goes in a “decide later” box so it isn't staring at you for the rest of the hour.

Stretch 3 • 15 min — Surfaces & shine — 0:25 – 0:40

Dust and wipe from top down: shelves, counters, tabletops, switch plates. Finish with the floor. A clean surface is what makes a room feel reset, even if one corner is still being decided on.

Stretch 4 • 5 min — Sit-down break. Water. Phone down. — 0:40 – 0:45

This is not skippable. Sit in the cleaned zone and enjoy it for five full minutes. The stretch that you skip is the one that makes the last stretch miserable.

Stretch 5 • 15 min — Finish the floor — 0:45 – 1:00

Vacuum or mop, then leave the room. Tour it once on the way out with the door open. Jot down what worked, what got skipped, and what goes on the Drop Log.

Zone log (one line per hour)

DATE	ZONE / ROOM	START	FINISHED?	SKIP / SAVE FOR NEXT TIME

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Low-energy day? Half-hour zone timer.

Halve everything: 5 min trash • 10 min return • 5 min dust • 5 min rest • 5 min floor. Five minutes is a real zone. Done is done.

The magic is the stopwatch, not the span. Started beats perfect; stopped-on-purpose beats gone-all-Saturday.